PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Monday, December 8, 2025

Jefferson High School Enrollment Scenario Proposal Listening Session

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Jefferson High School Enrollment Scenario Proposal Listening Session of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Jefferson High School - Auditorium, 5210 N Kerby Ave, Portland, Oregon 97217 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Present:
Chair Eddie Wang; Vice-Chair Michelle DePass; Directors Rashelle Chase-Miller, Stephanie Engelsman, Virginia LaForte, Christy Splitt; Student Representative Ian Ritorto; and Superintendent Kimberlee Armstrong

Absent:
Director Patte Sullivan

Jefferson High School Enrollment Scenario Proposal Listening Session

Time: 6:10 pm

Staff: Margaret Calvert – Assistant Superintendent, School Planning and Modernization

The meeting was called to order at 6:10 pm by Board Chair Eddie Wang. Interpreters introduced themselves, and Principal Drake Shelton welcomed families to Jefferson. Chair Wang provided comments on behalf of the Board in reflection of the recent Regular Meeting, and highlighting the Board's commitment to professional conduct and indicating the culture the new Board seeks to establish.

Superintendent Armstrong explained the timing of her proposal, noting that additional opportunities for public comment and Board discussion will continue, with a final Board decision anticipated in January. Staff presented an overview of the Superintendent's enrollment scenario, including the planning and engagement process, a phased implementation timeline, projected enrollment and utilization data, visualizations of school boundaries and distances, and the anticipated benefits of boundary changes.

Public Comment:

- Sophia Lively – Not in support of any of the scenarios, now is not the time to adjust the enrollment boundaries.
- Grove Toulson – In support of scenario B.
- Lily Fogarty – In support of scenario B, urging the Board not to divide students from Harriet Tubman.
- Jessica Moss – In support of scenario B, urging the Board to not dividing students from Harriet Tubman.
- Laura Westwood –Of the proposed scenarios option C is the most balanced, however is in support of the community's proposed scenario F.
- Josh Moss – In support of scenario C with a commitment to ensure parody in programming to other Comprehensive High Schools in the first phase of implementation.
- Kristen Jessie-Uyanik – In support of scenario B and keeping Harriet Tubman student together.
- Eileen Flynn – Not in support of including Sabin in the enrollment balancing scenarios.

- Jason Greenblatt – In support of the investment in Jefferson High School, but not in support of including Sabin in the enrollment balancing.
- Haley Hatfield – Not in support of including Sabin or Irvington in the enrollment balancing scenarios.
- Bina Patel – Not in support of including Sabin in the enrollment balancing scenarios.
- Mike Westling – In support of scenario B with a commitment to ensure parody in programming to other Comprehensive High Schools in the first phase of implementation.
- Todd Johnson – In support of either scenario B or C with a commitment to ensure parody in programming to other Comprehensive High Schools in the first phase of implementation.
- Sara Schultz – In support of plan B and keeping Harriet Tubman together.
- Michelle DuBarry – In support of plan B
- Stephanie McBride – In support of neighborhood schools being within a mile of their school, and option C.
- Mishka Willis – Not in support of including Sabin in the enrollment balancing.
- Abdul Rahimi – Not in support of any of the proposed scenarios.
- Liz Thorne – In support of scenario B with a commitment to ensure parody in programming to other Comprehensive High Schools in the first phase of implementation, and could be in support of scenario C with more clear plan.
- Amy Fauver – In support of scenario C.
- Sarah Dillon – In support of scenario B with a commitment to ensure parody in programming to other Comprehensive High Schools in the first phase of implementation.
- Ren Simmons – In support of scenario B with a commitment to ensure parody in programming to other Comprehensive High Schools in the first phase of implementation.
- Dr. Carmen P. Thompson – Provided historical racial context to the discussion.
- Sean Fogarty – In support of scenario B with a commitment to ensure parody in programming to other Comprehensive High Schools in the first phase of implementation.
- Eloise Koehler – In support of the plan that is best for Jefferson's enrollment with parody in programming to other Comprehensive High Schools in the first phase of implementation.
- Erin Brasell – In support of the plan that best supports the enrollment balancing process.
- Gina Levine – In support of scenario B with a commitment to ensure parody in programming to other Comprehensive High Schools in the first phase of implementation.
- Maria Hein – Not in support of including Sabin in the enrollment balancing.
- Chris Boyce – Not in support of any of the proposed scenarios, noting the flawed engagement process.
- Danielle Moser – In support of her students attending Jefferson with comprehensive academic offerings.
- Kate Lefco – Excited to be part of Jefferson.
- Addie Humbert – Students are going to be fine at Jefferson High School, noting the unique opportunity to teach children about change and community.
- Bethany Wofford – Shared support for the scenario that is best for all schools and students, while ensuring each school has the resources it needs. Urged the Board to no carve out parts of the boundaries for one school.
- Maria Lalli – In support of scenario B with a commitment to ensure parody in programming to other Comprehensive High Schools in the first phase of implementation.
- Courtney Crowe – In support of scenario B with a commitment to ensure parody in programming to other Comprehensive High Schools in the first phase of implementation.
- Nate Appy – In support of scenario B with a commitment to ensure parody in programming to other Comprehensive High Schools in the first phase of implementation.
- Elizabeth Osberger – In support of scenario B, and opposes scenario C.
- Jesse Merrithew – In support of plan B and keeping Harriet Tubman together, stating that scenario C allows wealthy families to avoid going to Jefferson.
- Jackie Hatfield – Requested that they keep her grandkids feeding into Grant High School.
- Kathryn Stoumen – In support of her students attending Jefferson with a plan for comprehensive programming.
- Ben Loftis – In support of scenario B.
- Katie Leathers – Noted that many students who live in Irvington are not affluent parents. Her opposition to the proposed scenarios is due to the proximity of each school.
- Jennifer Duncan – In support of sunsetting the dual assignment and scenario C.

- Nnenna Lewis – Shared that black communities have walked, bused and been shipped out of the neighborhood for generations, urging people to join Jefferson in community.
- Natasha Coleman – Urged the Board to focus on community and not white entitlement from the same people who created gentrification in the first place.
- James Roberson – This is an opportunity to resource Jefferson. Black communities were bused much further than any of the current options propose.

Chair Wang noted that the Board will next discuss the proposal at the upcoming Work Session scheduled for Tuesday, December 16, 2025.

The meeting was adjourned at 8:35pm by Board Chair Wang.

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw

Executive Assistant / Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools